

MAYBEWELL BOOKS ★

FIELD NOTES · VOLUME FIVE

Questions They Never Ask You

A Conversation Manual for Dinners, Car Rides, and Waiting Rooms
Preguntas que Nunca te Hacen



A CONVERSATION BOOK

these are the ones worth asking.

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HOW TO USE THIS

Before You Begin

Most conversation starters ask the same six questions in different clothes. This book doesn't. Every question here was picked because it's specific enough to get a real answer instead of a rehearsed one.

This book works in two moves:

ASK Pick a question — in order or at random. Read it out loud to whoever you're with. Give it a second before anyone answers; the good answers usually come after the pause.

ANSWER Both of you write your own answer, in your own space, at the same time. Read them out loud after — not before. The differences are the interesting part.

There's no scoring, no winning, no correct answer. A short answer is still an honest one.

Pick a question. Ask it out loud. See what comes back.

SECTION ONE · 8 QUESTIONS

Odd & Absurd

No wrong answers here — just the more interesting ones.

ASK

If you had to teach a stranger one skill in 10 minutes, what would you pick?

ANSWER ONE _____ *name*

ANSWER TWO _____ *name*

ASK

If you could swap lives with one animal for exactly one day, which would you choose?

ANSWER ONE _____ *name*

ANSWER TWO _____ *name*

ASK

What's the strangest thing you've ever eaten on a dare
— or almost did?

ANSWER ONE _____ *name*

ANSWER TWO _____ *name*

ASK

If your life had a laugh track, what moment would it play right now?

ANSWER ONE _____ *name*

ANSWER TWO _____ *name*

ASK

What's one food combination you love that everyone else finds disgusting?

ANSWER ONE _____ *name*

ANSWER TWO _____ *name*

ASK

If you had to give up one sense for a year to keep the other four sharper, which would you give up?

ANSWER ONE _____ *name*

ANSWER TWO _____ *name*

ASK

What's the weirdest thing you've ever looked up at 2 a.m.?

ANSWER ONE _____ *name*

ANSWER TWO _____ *name*

ASK

If you could instantly become fluent in one made-up language, which fictional one would you pick?

ANSWER ONE _____ *name*

ANSWER TWO _____ *name*

SECTION TWO · 8 QUESTIONS

Quietly Deep

Slow down for these. They reward it.

ASK

What's something you believed as a child that you were embarrassed to unlearn?

ANSWER ONE _____ name

ANSWER TWO _____ name

ASK

What's a rule you follow that you've never explained to anyone?

ANSWER ONE _____ *name*

ANSWER TWO _____ *name*

ASK

What does "home" actually mean to you, beyond an address?

ANSWER ONE _____ *name*

ANSWER TWO _____ *name*

ASK

What's a compliment you received once that you still think about?

ANSWER ONE _____ *name*

ANSWER TWO _____ *name*

ASK

What's something you're quietly proud of that no one ever asks about?

ANSWER ONE _____ *name*

ANSWER TWO _____ *name*

ASK

What would you want people to remember about how you made them feel?

ANSWER ONE _____ *name*

ANSWER TWO _____ *name*

ASK

What's a fear you've never said out loud?

ANSWER ONE _____ *name*

ANSWER TWO _____ *name*

ASK

What's something you forgive yourself for now that you didn't used to?

ANSWER ONE _____ *name*

ANSWER TWO _____ *name*

SECTION THREE · 8 QUESTIONS

About the Past

Old ground, asked in a way that makes it new again.

ASK

What's a smell that instantly takes you back to being a kid?

ANSWER ONE _____ *name*

ANSWER TWO _____ *name*

ASK

What's the first thing you remember wanting to be when you grew up?

ANSWER ONE _____ *name*

ANSWER TWO _____ *name*

ASK

What's a small decision that changed the direction of your life?

ANSWER ONE _____ *name*

ANSWER TWO _____ *name*

ASK

Who was the first person who ever really believed in you?

ANSWER ONE _____ *name*

ANSWER TWO _____ *name*

ASK

What's a place from your childhood you wish you could visit one more time?

ANSWER ONE _____ name

ANSWER TWO _____ name

ASK

What's something you got in trouble for that you'd do again?

ANSWER ONE _____ *name*

ANSWER TWO _____ *name*

ASK

What's the best piece of advice you ignored — and later wished you hadn't?

ANSWER ONE _____ *name*

ANSWER TWO _____ *name*

ASK

What did a year of your life look like that no one else was around to see?

ANSWER ONE _____ *name*

ANSWER TWO _____ *name*

SECTION FOUR · 8 QUESTIONS

About Right Now

Present tense. No looking back, no looking ahead.

ASK

If today had a soundtrack, what's the one song stuck in it?

ANSWER ONE _____ *name*

ANSWER TWO _____ *name*

ASK

What's something you're looking forward to this week that you haven't told anyone?

ANSWER ONE _____ *name*

ANSWER TWO _____ *name*

ASK

What's occupying more of your headspace than it probably should right now?

ANSWER ONE _____ *name*

ANSWER TWO _____ *name*

ASK

What's the last thing that made you genuinely laugh out loud?

ANSWER ONE _____ *name*

ANSWER TWO _____ *name*

ASK

If you had one unplanned free hour today, what would you actually do with it?

ANSWER ONE _____ *name*

ANSWER TWO _____ *name*

ASK

What's a small thing that's been going right lately that you haven't celebrated?

ANSWER ONE _____ *name*

ANSWER TWO _____ *name*

ASK

What's something you're currently learning, on purpose or by accident?

ANSWER ONE _____ *name*

ANSWER TWO _____ *name*

ASK

What mood best describes you today, in exactly one word?

ANSWER ONE _____ *name*

ANSWER TWO _____ *name*

SECTION FIVE · 8 QUESTIONS

About Someone Else at the Table

Turn these outward. The best answers are about the person across from you.

ASK

What's one thing about the person to your right that you've always admired but never said out loud?

ANSWER ONE _____ *name*

ANSWER TWO _____ *name*

ASK

Think of whoever's been quietest tonight — what do you think they're thinking about right now?

ANSWER ONE _____ *name*

ANSWER TWO _____ *name*

ASK

What's a strength in someone else at this table that they probably underestimate?

ANSWER ONE _____ *name*

ANSWER TWO _____ *name*

ASK

If you had to guess, what's on someone else's mind that they haven't shared tonight?

ANSWER ONE _____ *name*

ANSWER TWO _____ *name*

ASK

What's something you've learned from someone here without them ever teaching it on purpose?

ANSWER ONE _____ *name*

ANSWER TWO _____ *name*

ASK

Who here would you trust with a secret, and why?

ANSWER ONE _____ *name*

ANSWER TWO _____ *name*

ASK

What's a compliment you've never said to someone at this table — and why not?

ANSWER ONE _____ *name*

ANSWER TWO _____ *name*

ASK

If you could ask one person here anything and get an honest answer, what would you ask?

ANSWER ONE _____ *name*

ANSWER TWO _____ *name*

SECTION SIX · 8 QUESTIONS

Hypotheticals

Made up, but the answers never are.

ASK

If you woke up tomorrow with any one superpower, which would you pick — and would you actually tell anyone?

ANSWER ONE _____ name

ANSWER TWO _____ name

ASK

If you could relive one ordinary day exactly as it happened, which would you choose?

ANSWER ONE _____ *name*

ANSWER TWO _____ *name*

ASK

If you had to move to a country you've never visited, tomorrow, which would you pick?

ANSWER ONE _____ *name*

ANSWER TWO _____ *name*

ASK

If you could send a message back to yourself five years ago, what's the one thing you'd say?

ANSWER ONE _____ *name*

ANSWER TWO _____ *name*

ASK

If you had to trade your phone for one object for a month, what would you pick?

ANSWER ONE _____ name

ANSWER TWO _____ name

ASK

If you could instantly master one skill overnight, what would you choose — and what would you do with it first?

ANSWER ONE _____ *name*

ANSWER TWO _____ *name*

ASK

If your life became a book tomorrow, what would the title be?

ANSWER ONE _____ *name*

ANSWER TWO _____ *name*

ASK

If you could have dinner with any three people, living or not, who would be at the table?

ANSWER ONE _____ *name*

ANSWER TWO _____ *name*

Out of questions? Good.

That means it's time to make up your own.

48 questions · 6 sections · ∞

Share your favorite answer: #QuestionsTheyNeverAskYou



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